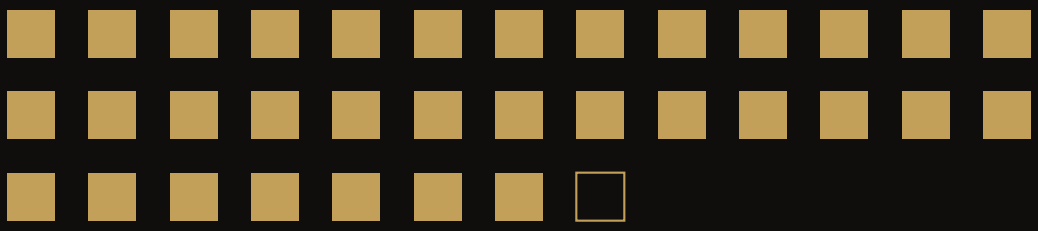
A FREE GUIDE FROM [BUSINESS NAME]

EDITION 01

The Move-Out Cleaning Checklist

Get your deposit back.



34 TASKS

4 ZONES / 1 WALKTHROUGH

ROOM BY ROOM / PRINTABLE / FREE

[SERVICE AREA]

Clean it like you're being inspected.

When you move out, your landlord compares the home to how it looked when you moved in. Normal wear and tear is expected. Dirt, grease and grime usually aren't, and cleaning charges come straight out of your deposit.

This checklist covers the 34 tasks inspectors check most, grouped by room. Print it, tick each box and take photos as you go.

YOUR TIMELINE

2 weeks out	Read your lease for cleaning terms. Find your move-in photos or inspection report. Book carpet cleaning if it's required.
1 week out	Clean inside empty cabinets, closets and the oven while you still have time to spare.
Moving day	Once the furniture is out, do walls, baseboards and floors last, working toward the door.
Before you hand over keys	Do the final walkthrough on page 07 and photograph every room.

SUPPLIES

- [ ] All-purpose cleaner
- [ ] Bathroom / descaling cleaner
- [ ] Scrub brush & sponge
- [ ] Mop & bucket
- [ ] Degreaser
- [ ] Glass cleaner
- [ ] Magic eraser
- [ ] Trash bags
- [ ] Oven cleaner
- [ ] Microfiber cloths
- [ ] Vacuum with crevice tool
- [ ] Phone for photos

The rule: top to bottom, back to front, dry before wet.

Kitchen

Grease and crumbs are the most common reasons for a cleaning charge. Start here while you have energy.

01	☐	Empty, wipe and dry every cabinet and drawer, inside and out
02	☐	Degrease cabinet fronts, handles and the range hood filter
03	☐	Clean the oven interior, racks and door glass
04	☐	Clean stovetop, burners, drip pans and knobs
05	☐	Pull the stove out; clean the sides and the floor beneath
06	☐	Empty, defrost if needed, and wipe the fridge and freezer
07	☐	Pull the fridge out; vacuum the coils and the floor beneath
08	☐	Run the dishwasher empty; wipe the door seal and filter
09	☐	Scrub the sink, faucet and drain; run the disposal
10	☐	Wipe the microwave inside, outside and the turntable
11	☐	Wipe countertops and the backsplash

NOTES / PHOTOS TAKEN

Bathrooms

Landlords look closely at grout, hard-water spots and the base of the toilet.

- 01 ☐ Scrub tub, shower walls and grout; remove soap scum
- 02 ☐ Descale the showerhead and faucets
- 03 ☐ Clean shower door tracks, or replace a mildewed curtain liner
- 04 ☐ Clean the toilet inside, outside, under the seat and at the base
- 05 ☐ Empty and wipe the vanity, drawers and medicine cabinet
- 06 ☐ Polish mirrors and chrome fixtures
- 07 ☐ Clean the exhaust fan cover
- 08 ☐ Scrub the floor along the edges and behind the toilet

NOTES / PHOTOS TAKEN

Bedrooms & Living Areas

Empty rooms show everything. Work top to bottom so dust falls onto floors you haven't cleaned yet.

- 01 ☐ Dust ceiling fans, light fixtures and vents
- 02 ☐ Remove nails and hooks; patch small holes if your lease allows
- 03 ☐ Spot-clean scuffs and marks on walls and doors
- 04 ☐ Wipe light switches, outlets and door handles
- 05 ☐ Wipe baseboards and door frames
- 06 ☐ Empty closets; wipe shelves and rods
- 07 ☐ Clean window sills and tracks; wash the inside glass
- 08 ☐ Dust and wipe blinds

NOTES / PHOTOS TAKEN

Floors, Entry & Extras

Floors come last, on your way out of each room.

- 01 ☐ Vacuum carpets, including edges and inside closets
- 02 ☐ Treat carpet stains, or book a professional shampoo if your lease requires it
- 03 ☐ Sweep and mop hard floors, working toward the door
- 04 ☐ Clean the laundry area, washer seal and dryer lint trap
- 05 ☐ Sweep the balcony, patio or garage
- 06 ☐ Replace burned-out bulbs and dead smoke-detector batteries
- 07 ☐ Take out all trash and remove everything you own

NOTES / PHOTOS TAKEN

The last ten minutes.

Walk every room slowly with your phone camera on. This record is your best protection if a charge is disputed later.

- [ ] Photograph or video every room, closet, appliance interior and bathroom
- [ ] Open every cabinet, drawer and appliance one last time
- [ ] Check that every light works and every window locks
- [ ] Confirm nothing is left behind, including in the garage, storage and mailbox
- [ ] Return all keys, fobs and remotes, and get a receipt or email confirmation
- [ ] Give the landlord your forwarding address in writing for the deposit
- [ ] Ask to attend the move-out inspection if your landlord offers one

MOST-MISSED SPOTS

- Inside the oven
- Bathroom grout
- Baseboards
- Inside drawers
- Behind the fridge
- Window tracks
- Range hood filter
- Light fixtures

Deposit rules and return deadlines vary by state and city. Check your lease and local tenant rules if a deduction seems unfair.

Hand us the checklist.

We'll do all of it.

[BUSINESS NAME] does move-in and move-out cleaning across [SERVICE AREA]. We follow every line of this checklist, so you can spend moving day moving.

REQUEST A FREE QUOTE

[PHONE] / [EMAIL] / [WEBSITE]

WE REPLY WITHIN ONE BUSINESS DAY